

British
Bangladeshi

2025



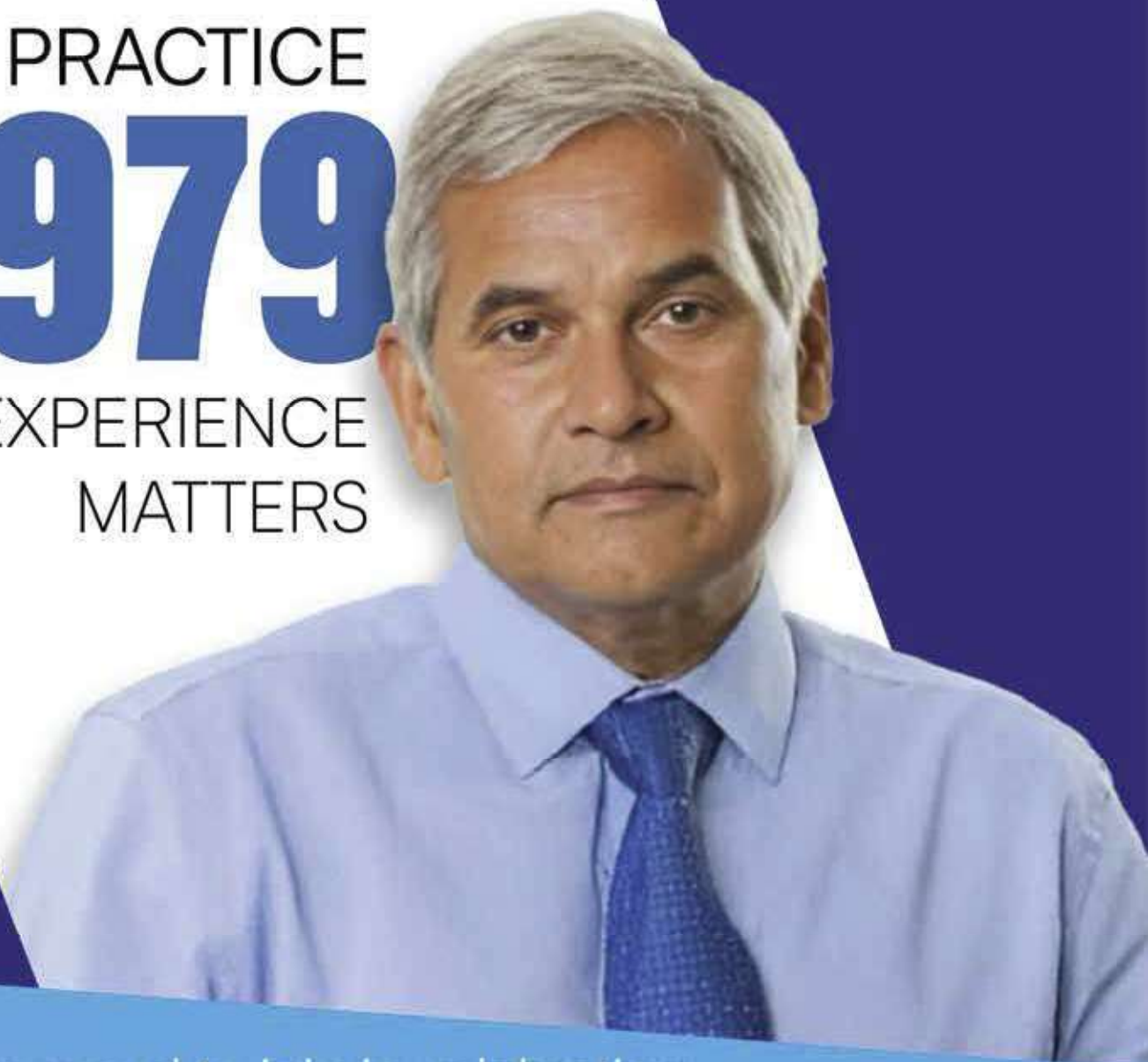
ACCOUNTANTS' DAY



THE
**PROFESSIONAL
ACCOUNTANTS**
SOCIETY

Bhardwaj
INSOLVENCY PRACTITIONERS

IN PRACTICE
SINCE 1979
EXPERIENCE
MATTERS



We are proud to join in celebrating
**British Bangladeshi
Accountants' Day 2025**

We extend our heartfelt thanks to everyone who makes this day a success, honouring the contribution, talent, and leadership of British Bangladeshi accountants.

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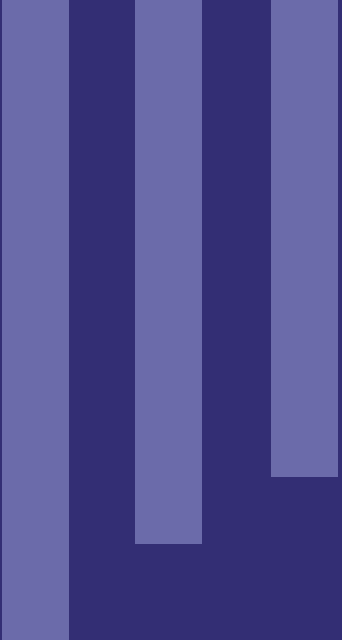
47-49 Green Ln,
Northwood HA6 3AE



Organised by



*Connecting the excellence of British
Bangladeshi Chartered Accountants.*



“Adding Value, Beyond Numbers”

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MESSAGE FROM

H.E. BANGLADESH HIGH COMMISSIONER

It is with great pleasure that I extend my warmest greetings on the occasion of British Bangladeshi Accountants' Day 2025, organized by the Professional Accountants' Society.

The British Bangladeshi accounting community has earned widespread recognition for its professionalism and integrity. Their invaluable contributions strengthen the UK's financial and business landscape while bringing immense pride to Bangladesh. This event is an admirable initiative that not only honors present accomplishments but also inspires the next generation of professionals. It underscores the vital role of accountants in driving economic growth and upholding good governance.

I encourage our distinguished accountants to further explore collaboration with Bangladesh, particularly in the field of outsourcing. Bangladesh has emerged as a dynamic hub for financial services, offering a skilled workforce and cost-effective solutions. By forging stronger professional linkages, you can play a pivotal role in expanding bilateral cooperation and contributing to shared prosperity.

I warmly congratulate the Professional Accountants' Society for organizing this meaningful event and extend my best wishes for its continued success.

May this celebration further strengthen the bonds within our community and deepen the enduring relationship between Bangladesh and the United Kingdom.



Abida Islam

ABIDA ISLAM

High Commissioner of
Bangladesh to the United Kingdom
of Great Britain and Northern Ireland &
Permanent Representative of
Bangladesh to the IMO

Praising the community's professionalism and contributions to the UK economy while encouraging greater collaboration with Bangladesh in financial services and outsourcing.

MESSAGE FROM

ASSISTANT HIGH COMMISSIONER

It is an honor for me to extend my warmest greetings to all the distinguished guests, members, and participants of the 'British Bangladeshi Accountants' Day 2025,' organized by The Professional Accountants' Society. This event is a testament to the remarkable success and vibrant spirit of the British Bangladeshi community.

The United Kingdom and Bangladesh share a deep-rooted bond, and it is through the dedication and hard work of individuals like the professional accountants that this relationship continues to flourish and strengthen, bridging our two nations in a meaningful way.

Your contributions to the UK's economic and financial landscape are commendable. I wish to express my sincere appreciation for your collective efforts and your unwavering commitment to excellence.

May this day be a source of inspiration for not only accounting professionals but also other professionals of Bangladeshi diaspora. I wish The Professional Accountants' Society and all attendees success in their professional as well as personal life.



A white handwritten signature on a dark blue background, consisting of stylized initials and a surname.

MR. MOHAMMAD JOBAYED HOSEN

ASSISTANT HIGH COMMISSIONER
THE PEOPLE'S REPUBLIC OF
BANGLADESH, MANCHESTER, UK

Dedication and contributions to the UK economy, highlighting their role in strengthening UK—Bangladesh ties.

MESSAGE FROM

CEO, Hillingdon Chamber of Commerce

I'm delighted to congratulate the Professional Accountants Society on hosting British Bangladeshi Accountants' Day 2025.

This event is a wonderful opportunity to celebrate the achievements of British Bangladeshi accountants and the huge contribution they make to our business community — locally and nationally. Their skills and commitment play a big part in helping businesses succeed, encouraging entrepreneurship, and driving growth.

The Professional Accountants Society has created a fantastic space for learning, networking, and supporting one another. Events like this bring people together, spark new ideas, and inspire the next generation of accountants and business leaders.

On behalf of the Hillingdon Chamber of Commerce, I'm proud to support this celebration and I look forward to seeing even more success from the British Bangladeshi accounting community in the years to come.



Andy Sharma

CEO,

Hillingdon Chamber of Commerce



MESSAGE FROM

The Vice Chair, Newham Chamber of Commerce

Newham Chamber of Commerce is delighted to attend this important celebration of British Bangladeshi Accountants' Day 2025. This event not only highlights the talent, dedication, and hard work of those within the profession, but also reflects the vital contribution the British Bangladeshi community makes to our business and wider society.

We are proud to stand alongside you in recognising these achievements and celebrating the success of all involved.



Aaron Uthman

Vice Chair of NCC

E: vicechair@newhamchamber.com



Message From **Chair, Organising Committee** **British-Bangladeshi Accountants' Day 2025**

It is my great pride and pleasure to welcome you to the inaugural British Bangladeshi Accountants' Day 2025, organised by The Professional Accountants' Society.

Since the early 1970s, British Bangladeshi Accountants have played a vital role in shaping the UK's financial sector and economy. Today, we come together to honour that legacy, celebrate our achievements, and look ahead to a future filled with even greater promise.

The founding members of The Professional Accountants' Society chose to establish a day that celebrates not only our achievements as accountants, but also the values of hard work, resilience, and excellence that define our community.

The mission of The Professional Accountants' Society has always been clear: to build a strong bridge between accountants and the wider business community. We strive to provide expert guidance that helps businesses grow and succeed, while also mentoring the next generation of talent. Our goal is to inspire young people to pursue rewarding careers in finance and accountancy, and to empower them to thrive in the mainstream accountancy profession.

We also envision a broader impact. We aim to work closely with relevant government bodies in both the UK and Bangladesh to foster collaboration, create employment opportunities, and strengthen economic ties between our two nations.

From this year onwards, the last Saturday of September each year will be commemorated as British Bangladeshi Accountants' Day—a lasting symbol of pride, unity, and hope for our community. This is not just an event—it is the beginning that will inspire generations to come.

On behalf of the Organising Committee, I extend my deepest gratitude to our sponsors, distinguished guests, and fellow founding members. Your unwavering support and dedication have made this day possible.

Together, we are not just celebrating—we are making history.



A stylized, handwritten signature in white ink on a dark blue background.

Suraiya Khatun Mili (FCCA)

Chair, Organising Committee
British Bangladeshi Accountants' Day 2025
Founding member of
The Professional Accountants' Society

MESSAGE FROM

Guarantor & Director

On behalf of founding members

It is both a privilege and a personal honour to contribute a message in this special edition of the British Bangladeshi Accountants' Day 2025 magazine, published by The Professional Accountants' Society.

As one of the Guarantors and Directors of The Professional Accountants' Society, I take immense pride in contributing to an organisation that champions professionalism, integrity, and community spirit. The Society's mission is to advance the accounting profession by providing support, education, and networking opportunities for its members, while upholding the highest standards of ethical practice. Its vision is to be a leading platform that empowers accountants of British Bangladeshi origin to excel, inspire, and make meaningful contributions to society.

This day is not only about celebrating the achievements of British Bangladeshi Accountants', but also about recognising the resilience, hard work, and vision that our community brings to the wider society and economy. Accountants play a vital role as guardians of transparency, trust, and accountability. Their expertise safeguards businesses, strengthens governance, and inspires confidence within our communities and beyond.

Today, as we celebrate our collective journey, we also acknowledge the younger generation who aspire to join this profession and take it to even greater heights. May this day serve as a reminder of how far we have come, and as an inspiration for what we can continue to achieve together. I am deeply committed to standing alongside the Professional Accountants' Society as it builds platforms of excellence and unity for our profession.



Mohammed Iftekharul Islam Chowdhury
(M.Sc, FCCA)

Guarantor & Director
on behalf of founding members of
The Professional Accountants' Society



THE Editor

It is with immense pride and joy that I welcome you to this special edition of our event magazine, published to mark British Bangladeshi Accountants' Day 2025, organised by The Professional Accountants' Society.

This day is more than a celebration—it is a recognition of the hard work, dedication, and achievements of British Bangladeshi accountants who continue to contribute meaningfully to the profession, the economy, and our community. As a society, we stand as a bridge between tradition and progress, fostering excellence while inspiring the next generation to aim higher.

Our profession is not just about numbers—it is about integrity, trust, and responsibility. Through this magazine, we aim to highlight the journeys of our members, share valuable insights, and showcase the collective strength of our community.

On this occasion, I extend my heartfelt gratitude to all contributors, sponsors, and supporters who made this celebration possible. Most importantly, I applaud each of our members whose commitment and expertise bring pride to our community and inspire future accountants to follow in their footsteps.

Together, let us continue to strengthen our network, uphold professional values, and create new opportunities for growth and collaboration.

Wishing you all a successful and inspiring British Bangladeshi Accountants' Day 2025.



Md Khasruzzaman

(MBA, MAAT, FCCA)

Founding member , Guarantor & Director of
The Professional Accountants' Society





**THE
PROFESSIONAL
ACCOUNTANTS
SOCIETY**

*Connecting the excellence of British
Bangladeshi Chartered Accountants.*

ABOUT US

The Professional Accountants Society is a UK-based organisation representing British Bangladeshi Accountants. Our mission is to unite professionals of Bangladeshi heritage into one cohesive network that fosters collaboration, professional excellence, and community impact. We are committed to creating an environment where members can share technical knowledge, skills, and experiences to support one another professionally and personally. Through this collaboration, we aim to not only empower our members but also contribute positively to the wider business and professional community across the UK.

MISSION

To build a thriving, collaborative community that celebrates and connects the excellence of British Bangladeshi Chartered Accountants, empowering them to lead, inspire, and shape the future of the accounting profession.

VISION

To foster a strong network of British Bangladeshi Chartered Accountants in UK.

To promote professional development, mentorship, and mutual support.

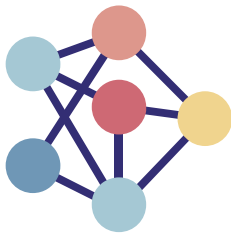
To highlight the achievements and contributions of our members across the UK and beyond.

To act as a bridge between generations of finance professionals, encouraging innovation, diversity, and integrity in accounting practices.

WHO WE ARE

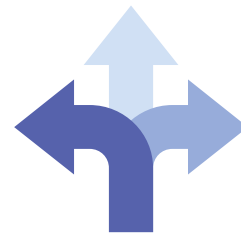
The Professional Accountants' Society is a platform formed by and for British Bangladeshi Chartered Accountants and finance professionals. We are a collective of individuals who share a commitment to professional excellence, ethical leadership, and community upliftment. Our members come from a wide range of industries — public practice, corporate finance, public sector, academia, and entrepreneurship — united by a shared heritage and a passion for financial stewardship.

WHAT WE DO



Networking & Collaboration

We organise professional meet-ups, seminars, and virtual forums to create opportunities for meaningful connections and collaborations.



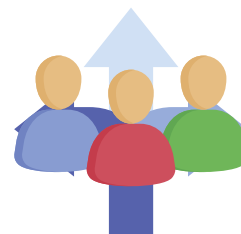
Mentorship & Guidance

Through structured mentorship programs, we support young professionals and students on their path to qualification and career success.



Recognition & Representation

We spotlight the success stories and impact of British Bangladeshi accountants to inspire the next generation and elevate our collective voice in the profession.



Community Engagement

We engage in social responsibility initiatives, encouraging our members to give back to the community and act as role models for others.

THE PROFESSIONAL ACCOUNTANTS' SOCIETY

513 London Road, Cheam, Sutton, England, SM3 8JR

admin@accountantsociety.org

www.accountantsociety.org

FOUNDING MEMBERS

Introducing the individuals who laid the cornerstone of our mission.



Mohammed Iftekharul Islam
Chowdhury (M.Sc., FCCA)



Suraiya Khatun Haque
BSc (Hons) FCCA



Mohammed Ali Ashraf
Chowdhury (MSc, FCCA)



MD Khasruzzaman
MBA, MAAT, FCCA



Hossain Al-Mamun
MBA, FTA, FCCA, ACA



Kazi Farhana Akhter
MAAT, FCCA



Afroza Amin Jhuma
LL.B, ACCA



Nazmul Hossain
MBA, MSc, FCCA



Md Mijanur Rahman
B Sc (Hons), FCCA



Mohammed Kamrul Aziz
MBA, ACCA



Harisa Islam



Md Tofazzel Hossain
ACCA



Anam Mahmud
M Sc., FCCA



Md Mahmudul Haque



MD Sultanul Abedin
ACCA



Mohammad Sarfaraz Ninad
ACCA, ARA, IAP



Md Alinur Rahman
MBA, FCCA



F M Raisul Ferdous
MBA, ACCA



Dabir Ahmed
FCCA, CPFA, FHEA



Accountants' Society Show: A Platform for **Impactful Engagement** with **Business and Community**

Dabir Ahmed

FCCA, CPFA, FHEA

The world of accounting is often seen as numbers on a page—but behind those numbers are people, businesses, and communities. That is the spirit driving The Accountants' Society Show, a live programme I am proud to host on iON TV (Sky Digital 782) every other Monday at 8pm. As one of the founding members of TPAS (The Professional Accountants' Society), I see this show as more than just a broadcast. It is a platform for learning, dialogue, and connection—bringing together professionals, entrepreneurs, and young people aspiring to join the next generation of accountants.

Three Dimensions of the Show

1. Technical Insight

We invite experts from TPAS and the wider professional community to share updates on taxation, accounting, finance, and regulations from HMRC and Companies House. Our goal is simple: to equip the business community with timely, relevant knowledge that supports compliance and informed decision-making.

2. Business and Community Engagement

The programme is interactive. Viewers email or text questions live, and we provide guidance or direct them to our TPAS Business Hub. This hub offers free mentorship, networking, and support for businesses. We also feature entrepreneurs who candidly share their journeys—their successes, their challenges, and their lessons. These stories inspire and provide practical insight into today's business landscape.

3. Education Corner

As accountants, we know we must one day pass the baton to the next generation. That is why the show highlights career paths, invites educators and recent graduates to share their perspectives, and offers mentorship opportunities. By opening the door to aspiring accountants, we help ensure a strong, diverse future for the profession.

An Open Invitation

Whether you are a professional, a business owner, or a student with dreams of becoming an accountant, The Accountants' Society Show is your show too. Join us, share your story, and be part of a community that blends technical expertise with real human impact.

For more information or to get involved, contact us at admin@accountantssociety.org.

Together, let's make accounting not just about numbers—but about people, progress, and purpose.

Bangladesh Needs More Chartered Accountants to Safeguard Its Economic Future

As Bangladesh moves toward its goal of becoming an upper-middle-income country, a critical challenge threatens progress: the shortage of Chartered Accountants (CAs). These professionals uphold transparency in government spending, integrity in business reporting, and accountability in both public and private finances. Without them, financial governance, tax collection, and investor confidence are at risk.

The Institute of Chartered Accountants of Bangladesh (ICAB) has only 2,000—2,200 members, of whom just 613 are licensed auditors—to serve over 300,000 registered businesses. Including Cost and Management Accountants (CMAs), the total number of qualified professionals is about 3,500—4,000. Yet Bangladesh needs at least three times this number; some estimates put the shortfall at 10,000+.

This shortage leads to:

- Weak tax compliance and widespread underreporting.
- Capacity gaps in ministries and state-owned enterprises.
- Lower investor confidence due to poor audit coverage.
- Greater risks of corruption and financial mismanagement.

The shortage of Chartered Accountants in Bangladesh stems from several factors. The training process is lengthy and demanding, and with stipends set very low, many students drop out before completing their qualification. Access to CA education is also heavily concentrated in urban centres, leaving rural and disadvantaged students with limited opportunities to enter the profession. On top of this, regulatory restrictions grant statutory audit rights exclusively to ICAB members, preventing other internationally recognised professionals, such as ACCA members, from contributing more fully to meeting the country's needs.

Bangladesh's economic achievements are impressive, but growing complexity increases risks of mismanagement and inefficiency. Chartered Accountants are guardians of trust—ensuring taxes are fairly collected, budgets are well-spent, and businesses report honestly.

Investing in this profession is not optional; it is essential to expand the tax base, attract foreign investment, and build public trust.

The shortage of CAs is an urgent but solvable challenge. With bold reforms, investment in education, and regulatory flexibility, Bangladesh can develop the professional pipeline it needs to safeguard its financial future and secure sustainable economic growth.

Nazmul Hossain

MBA, MSc, FCCA

Founding member, Guarantor & Director of
The Professional Accountants' Society

From Compliance Champions To Digital Architects: How **British-bangladeshi Professional Accountants** Shape Businesses And Contribute To The British Economy

Abstract

Moving beyond the traditional focus on restaurants and catering, this paper shows how British-Bangladeshi professional accountants now play a more strategic and transformative role across wider ethnic businesses and service sectors. British-Bangladeshi professional accountants have moved beyond routine tax compliance to become key drivers of digital transformation across ethnic minority businesses and the wider SME sector. Their evolution is examined against the backdrop of the UK's shifting tax landscape, particularly the introduction of Making Tax Digital (MTD). By combining socio-cultural capital with technical expertise, these professionals are not only helping SMEs navigate digital disruption but also strengthening resilience, productivity, and competitiveness in the UK economy. Their trajectory offers a powerful case study of how diaspora professionals act as cultural interpreters and regulatory intermediaries, bridging state policy with the lived realities of entrepreneurship in ethnic communities.

Introduction: A professional metamorphosis

The emergence of a highly educated class of British-Bangladeshi professional accountants, such as the founders and members of the Professional Accountants Society, marks a significant transformation within one of the United Kingdom's most entrepreneurial diaspora communities. Moving beyond reductive stereotypes of the curry house economy (Chatterjee, 2023), these professionals now occupy pivotal roles at the intersection of cultural competence, regulatory expertise, and technological innovation. This paper contends that their progression from compliance-focused practitioners to digital architects constitutes not only a professional evolution but also a meaningful contribution to the mainstream British economy. By enabling digital adoption across SMEs, British-Bangladeshi accountants are shaping the trajectory of businesses that form the backbone of UK economic activity.

Phase 1: The compliance champions

Initially, British-Bangladeshi accountants functioned primarily as compliance champions. This role remains vital, particularly for first-generation entrepreneurs who often encounter linguistic barriers, institutional mistrust, and limited familiarity with formalised systems. Their contribution in this phase can be understood across three dimensions: (a) Cultural competence: Serving as trusted interpreters of complex legislation, grounded in a shared cultural and linguistic framework; (b) Navigating complexity: Guiding businesses through regulatory challenges ranging from Brexit-related trade codes to R&D tax credits and IR35 reforms; and (c) Risk mitigation: Protecting businesses from financial penalties and HMRC scrutiny, thereby preserving both operational stability and reputational integrity.

By establishing themselves as indispensable guardians of compliance, these accountants created the foundation for their subsequent strategic evolution.

Phase 2: The ascendance of the digital architect

The implementation of MTD catalysed a profound transformation. British-Bangladeshi accountants expanded their remit, becoming digital architects whose expertise now extends beyond traditional financial services. Their contributions can be categorised into three interrelated domains:

Technology implementation and integration

They operate as de facto IT consultants by (a) advising on MTD-compliant cloud platforms (e.g., Xero, QuickBooks etc.) aligned to client needs; and (b) designing integrated digital ecosystems that link accounting software with point-of-sale systems, e-commerce platforms, and banking APIs to ensure seamless financial data flows.

Process re-engineering and change management

They facilitate operational transformation by (a) redesigning workflows to capture financial data digitally at source; and (b) training staff to enhance digital literacy and ensure effective adoption of new systems.

Data intermediation and strategic insight

Perhaps their most significant new function lies in transforming raw data into strategic value (Yigitbasioglu et al., 2023) such as (a) delivering real-time dashboards on profitability, cash flow, and key performance indicators; and (b) providing proactive advisory services that inform decisions on pricing, cost control, expansion, and investment.

Economic contribution: Beyond the balance sheet

The cumulative effect of these roles extends far beyond individual client outcomes. British-Bangladeshi Accountants contribute to the wider economy in four important ways: (a) Enhancing SME productivity by digitalising SMEs, the diaspora professional accountants directly tackle the UK's persistent productivity gap; (b) Fostering financial formalisation where these accountants encourage transparency and compliance, reducing reliance on informal practices and broadening the tax base; (c) Bridging the digital divide by ensuring that smaller, minority-owned firms are not marginalised in the UK's digital transition, thereby advancing economic inclusivity (Bhattarai, 2020); and (d) Generating employment where many establish their own thriving firms, creating high-skilled jobs within the professional services sector.

Conclusion: Architects of a modern, inclusive economy

The professional trajectory of British-Bangladeshi Accountants—from compliance champions to digital architects—represents a powerful narrative of adaptation and agency. Far from being passive responders to regulatory change, they have actively leveraged MTD to reposition themselves as strategic partners who build digital capacity within SMEs. Their cultural embeddedness fosters trust and uptake, while their technical expertise delivers tangible improvements in business performance.

This dual capability positions them as unique contributors to the UK economy, exemplifying how diaspora professionals bridge cultural boundaries, support regulatory implementation, and drive economic modernisation. In doing so, British-Bangladeshi professional accountants emerge not merely as service providers, but as architects of a more resilient, productive, and inclusive economic landscape.

Dr. Md Shahidul Islam

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MOVING TOWARDS A SUSTAINABLE ECOSYSTEM: REGULATORS, RECOGNISED QUALIFYING BODIES, AND UNIVERSITIES

As a qualified accountant with a background in audit and corporate finance, I transitioned into academia five years ago and have since been involved in professional bodies governance. Recently, I participated in a roundtable hosted by the Financial Reporting Council (FRC) UK, where representatives from several universities gathered to discuss degree accreditations by professional bodies. The discussions closely resonated with what I have encountered since joining the higher education. Reflections in this piece, combine my experience in both worlds and provide a perspective on multifaceted challenges of integrating professional exemptions into university degrees.

Exemptions: A Double-Edged Sword for Student Attraction and Success

Universities frequently use accreditations as a tool to attract students to their accounting and finance programmes. The appeal is clear—students often see exemptions as a fast track to professional qualifications, believing that this will enhance their employability. Is this perception somewhat misleading? While exemptions can streamline the academic journey, they do not guarantee accelerated career progression. Employers have diverse policies regarding the acceptance of exemptions, and in the UK, statutory audit qualifications still require a minimum of three years of supervised practical training, regardless of how quickly exams are completed. Moreover, the rigorous nature of accredited modules can lead to higher attrition rates, as students often find the workload and rigour of professional level examinations overwhelming when compared to other Business disciplines.

Expanding the Scope of Undergraduate Education

No longer confined to technical financial reporting and compliance, accounting professionals are emerging as strategic partners with diverse skills to guide organisations in navigating the modern business landscape. In the face of diverse capacities of accountants as finance directors, CFOs, financial storytellers, technology evangelists and sustainability champions, universities need to broaden undergraduate education through a more multi-disciplinary approach. Designing flexible courses that allow students to engage with various aspects of business allows contextual understanding of accounting and finance and achieves a holistic education that emphasises value creation, critical thinking, sustainable and ethical judgement.

Accreditation: Facilitator, Not a Barrier

I have observed that the accreditation process has become a source of frustration for many universities. The current accreditation process with some large professional bodies is often seen as a "tick-box exercise" that is excessively mechanical. Re-accreditations can be particularly onerous, with limited opportunities for meaningful dialogue between universities and professional bodies. Constructive interaction between universities and professional bodies during this process can facilitate, rather than obstruct, educational innovation.

Addressing the Front-Loading of Qualifications

The current structure of accredited programmes can place an excessive burden on both students and staff. The heavy workload and examination-based assessments can lead to burnout, wellbeing issues and high attrition rates, discouraging students from fully engaging with their studies. The challenge of attrition and retention has prompted some universities to consider moving away from professional bodies' accreditations altogether, with a few institutions already opting out. It is time to reconsider how we structure Accounting programmes to ensure they are sustainable and supportive of both students and faculty.

Reconsidering the Timing and Impact of Exemptions

The timing of when exemptions are granted are vital, given the rapid advancement and integration of the profession. Exemptions that are granted for on first- or second-year modules and courses, may be completed up to three years before a student enters the workforce. This can render some knowledge outdated, particularly in areas such as tax, where rules frequently change. I believe that a comprehensive review of the exemption process by RQBs and universities is essential to ensure that students remain well-informed, highly skilled, and prepared for the evolving demands.

The Case for Cross-Collaboration and Best Practices

Cross-collaboration among Recognised Qualifying Bodies (RQBs) to share best practices in implementing exemptions could help establish a consistent approach to university assessments, thereby enhancing the overall quality of education. This collaboration would be particularly beneficial in curriculum design to ensure content remains current, particularly in overloaded or frequently changing topics such as digitalisation or taxation.

The Need for Empirical Evidence and Ongoing Dialogue

There is a glaring lack of empirical evidence regarding the uptake of exemptions in the workplace, a gap that must be addressed. Understanding how exemptions influence career trajectories and whether they truly benefit graduates in the long term is crucial for informing future policies. Perhaps management of accreditations within universities, often delegated to a single academic staff member, needs a more sustainable approach. Continuous dialogue between universities, professional bodies, and regulators is essential to support the evolving needs of the profession.

Towards a Sustainable Ecosystem in Accounting Education

An observed fact over my 25-plus-year experiences on both professional and academic sides, lead me to advocate for the creation of a sustainable ecosystem in accounting education - an ecosystem that fosters collaboration between higher education, RQBs, and regulators.

It is apparent to me that everyone's goal is to produce well-rounded graduates equipped not only with technical expertise but also skills of future leaders. As we continue to navigate the future qualification and regulatory landscapes, it is up to us to foster open dialogue, embracing innovation and sustainability, and develop best in class accounting professionals.

Dani Saghafi (FCCA, FHEA, MBA)

Honorary Reader, Brunel Business School.

Email: dani.saghafi@brunel.ac.uk

What's Missing From **the** **Accounts?** **The Costs** **We Can't** **Afford to** **Ignore**

True and Fair: Rethinking the Legal Duties of Company Directors

accounts reflect economic reality. What's more, similar requirements are embedded across company law worldwide.

As Jo Fackler, Director of Global Affairs at SVI, explains:

"The True & Fair Project is an initiative that challenges the way financial profit is calculated. We aim to internalise externalities in the global financial system by ensuring that dependencies and negative impacts are recognised within financial statements, rather than being confined to a non-financial report"

The project builds on a legal opinion by George Bompas KC which confirmed that directors may be legally required to disclose sustainability issues in their accounts. As Jo puts it: "It's no longer just a question of whether companies should disclose climate-related risks and liabilities in the accounts; it's a question of when they are legally required to do so."

Imagine if nature sent businesses an invoice.

Every ton of carbon emitted, every gallon of water extracted (and river spoiled), every degraded ecosystem: what if all of this came with a bill?

Now imagine if society did the same

Every unpaid wage, every hour of unsafe or underpaid labour, every community left to shoulder the hidden costs of business decisions: what if those pending bills suddenly arrived on the boardroom table? These are not hypothetical costs but real, measurable consequences of economic activity that never appear in financial statements. Instead, they are externalised; shifted onto society, communities, and future generations.

The paradox is clear: while we speak endlessly about "sustainability", the financial system still struggles to articulate, let alone account for, the real costs of doing business. The result? Businesses as the central actors in capital markets and the stewards of global capital flows are judged on profits that exclude critical liabilities.

The True & Fair Project

Can financial statements really be considered "true and fair" if they ignore the environmental and social costs of doing business?

This is the gap the True & Fair Project, an initiative hosted by Social Value International (SVI), is working to close.

Under Section 393 of the UK Companies Act 2006, directors must not approve accounts unless they are satisfied, they give a "true and fair view" of the company. As the Financial Reporting Council has clarified, compliance with accounting standards alone is not enough and directors must also exercise judgment to ensure that

The Beauty of the Accounting System (But Not Yet in Practice)

Accounting framework already offers a way to bring hidden costs into view. International standards recognise the concept of constructive obligations, with liabilities that arise not from statute but from a company's commitments or the valid expectations of stakeholders. In principle, this means directors could choose to treat externalities such as carbon emissions or poor labour conditions as obligations requiring financial recognition.

As Jeremy Nicholls, an Ashoka Fellow and Advisor to SVI has argued, the system is already capable of doing this:

"All we need is for directors to construct obligations for those externalities, and for auditors to consider the completeness of constructive obligations as part of their opinion on whether accounts give a true and fair view. Then financial value would be aligned with public interest"

This perspective reframes externalities not as abstract ethical concerns but as concrete obligations that sit squarely within the accounting framework. It demonstrates that standards are not the barrier; rather, the barrier is the will to apply them. Directors and auditors have the tools to internalise externalities, embed sustainability into financial statements, and redefine what it means for profit to be truly fair.

The question now is whether directors are prepared to use the discretion they already have, and whether auditors are willing to test the completeness of those obligations. If accounting provides the framework, will the profession rise to the challenge of ensuring that tomorrow's accounts reflect the real costs of doing business?

Here are two key approaches that directors can take to meet the true and fair requirement in the context of sustainability issue

Two Key Approaches

Include a note in the financial statements

Directors can choose to add a note that discloses, for example, the impact of their resource use (such as the social cost of carbon). This ensures transparency to readers of the accounts without affecting the calculation of profit..

Make a commitment that becomes a constructive obligation

Directors can choose to deliberately construct commitments to take responsibility for their impacts on people and planet (for example, to pay for their social cost of carbon used). This becomes a "constructive obligation" when there is a valid expectation that the responsibility be discharged, most commonly in the form of a payment. Such commitments are recorded as financial provisions, just like other liabilities, until the payment has been made. At that point, the "externality" has been "internalised".

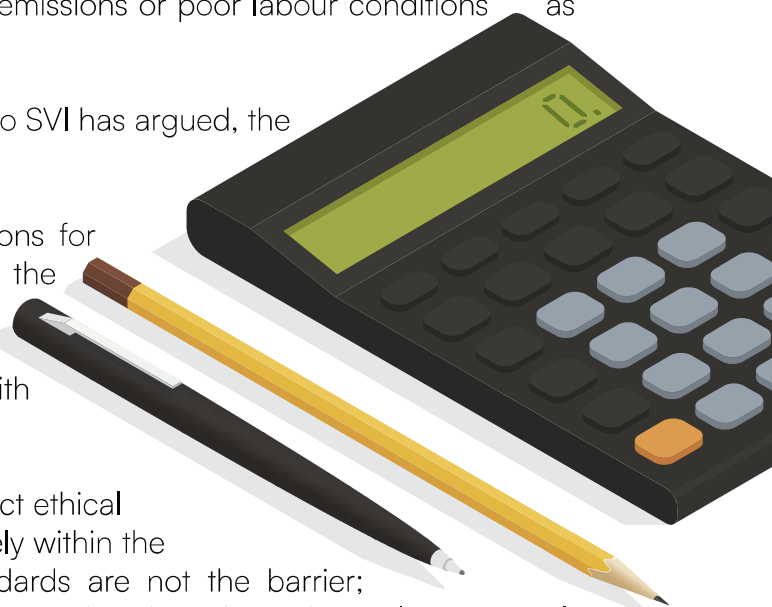
So, as you prepare to sign off your company's accounts, pause and reflect: are they truly "true and fair," or are hidden costs still left off the page?

Professor Ainurul Rosli

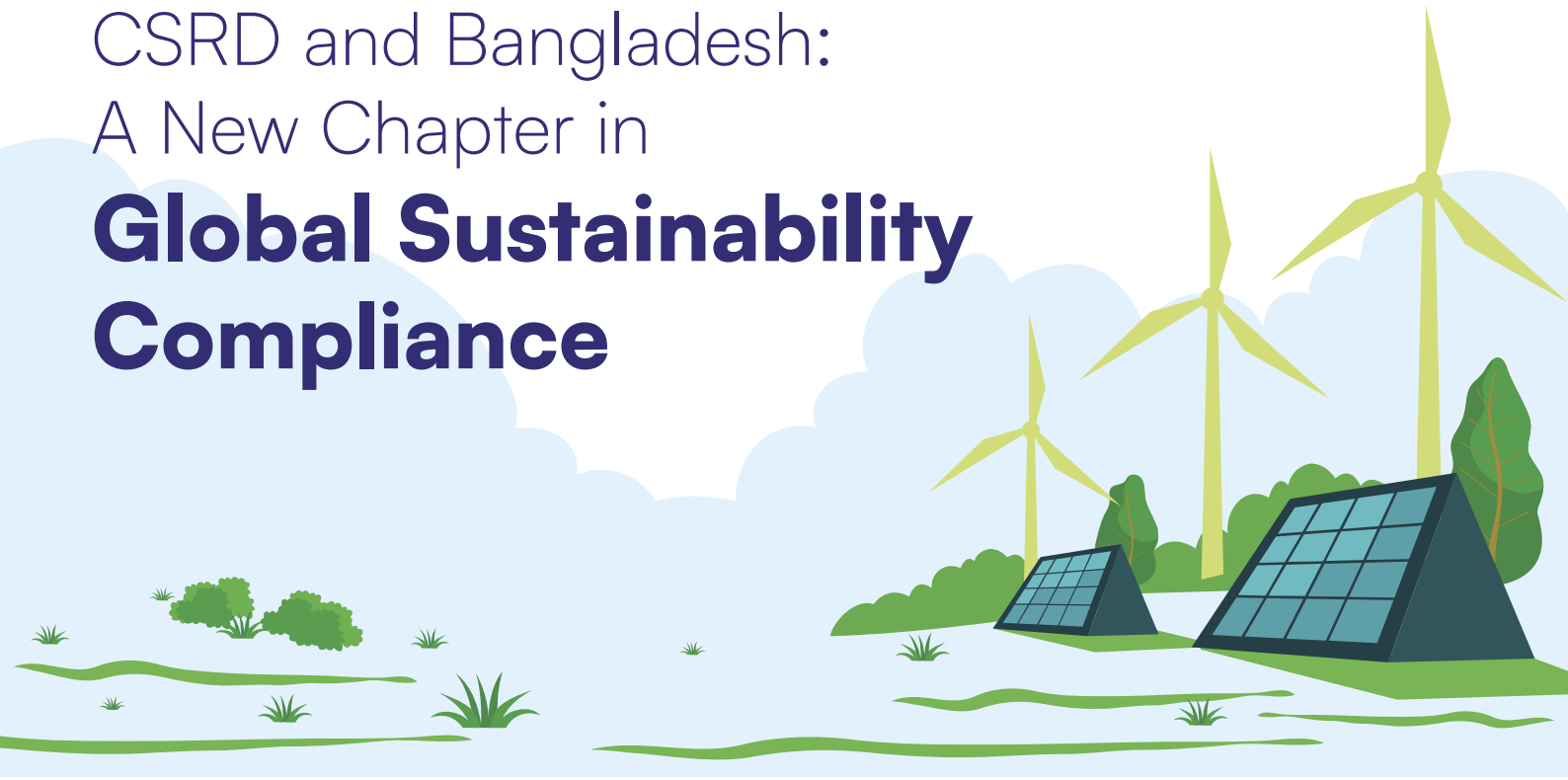
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CSRD and Bangladesh: A New Chapter in **Global Sustainability Compliance**



As global markets pivot toward transparency and ethical accountability, the European Union's Corporate Sustainability Reporting Directive (CSRD) is emerging as a transformative force. Designed to standardize and deepen sustainability disclosures across sectors, the CSRD is not just a European concern—it's a global signal. For Bangladesh, a country deeply embedded in EU supply chains, this directive presents both a challenge and a strategic opening.

The CSRD's Expanding Reach

The CSRD significantly broadens the scope of sustainability reporting, requiring companies to disclose how environmental and social factors affect their business—and how their operations impact society and the planet. This dual lens, known as double materiality, is central to the directive. It also mandates assurance of reported data and alignment with the European Sustainability Reporting Standards (ESRS), ensuring consistency across industries.

While the directive applies directly to EU-based companies, its reach extends to non-EU firms with substantial operations or subsidiaries in Europe. By 2028, even third-country parent companies with significant EU turnover will be required to report under CSRD. For Bangladesh, whose export economy is tightly linked to European buyers, this means local firms will increasingly be asked to provide CSRD-aligned data.

Implications for Bangladesh's Export Ecosystem

Bangladesh's ready-made garments (RMG), textiles, and leather industries are among the largest beneficiaries of EU trade. As European importers face stricter reporting obligations, they will demand ESG-compliant practices from their suppliers. This includes traceable data on emissions, labor conditions, governance structures, and risk management.

For Bangladeshi firms, particularly small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs), this shift could be daunting. Many lack the infrastructure for robust ESG reporting or the resources to engage assurance providers. However, those who adapt early will gain a competitive edge becoming preferred partners in a market that increasingly values ethical and sustainable sourcing.

Strategic Alignment and Institutional Readiness

Bangladesh has made commendable progress in sustainability reporting, with frameworks like the Global Reporting Initiative (GRI) gaining traction among larger firms. The Bangladesh Securities and Exchange Commission (BSEC) has also introduced ESG guidelines for listed companies. These efforts provide a foundation for CSRD alignment, but further steps are needed.

Key priorities include:

- Capacity building: Training programs for SMEs on ESG data collection, reporting standards, and assurance processes.
- Policy integration: National guidelines that mirror ESRS principles, enabling smoother compliance for firms engaged in EU trade.
- Digital infrastructure: Investment in platforms that streamline data management and reporting across supply chains.

Academic institutions and industry bodies can play a pivotal role here, offering research, technical support, and certification pathways that align with CSRD expectations.

Turning Compliance into Opportunity

Rather than viewing CSRD as a regulatory hurdle, Bangladesh can treat it as a catalyst for transformation. By embedding sustainability into business models, firms can unlock new markets, attract responsible investment, and enhance brand credibility. Moreover, aligning with CSRD can help Bangladesh position itself as a regional leader in ethical manufacturing and climate-conscious trade.

This transition also dovetails with Bangladesh's broader development goals, including its commitment to the UN Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) and its ambition to graduate from Least Developed Country (LDC) status. CSRD compliance can reinforce these trajectories, showcasing Bangladesh as a forward-looking, globally integrated economy.

Conclusion: A Call to Action

The CSRD is more than a European directive—it's a blueprint for the future of global business. For Bangladesh, the path to compliance is not without obstacles, but it is rich with possibility. With strategic investment, institutional coordination, and a commitment to ethical growth, Bangladesh can not only meet CSRD expectations but help shape the global sustainability narrative.



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Halal Home Finance in the UK:

Truly Shari'ah Compliant, Increasingly Affordable

Muslims in the UK are increasingly seeking ways to reconcile financial responsibility with religious conviction. Islamic mortgages—also known as Halal Home Purchase Plans (HPPs)—have emerged as a transformative solution for this market demand. Rooted in the ethical principles of Sharia (Islamic law), these financial products enable Muslims—and others seeking ethical finance—to own homes without compromising their values, particularly the Qur'anic prohibition of *riba* (interest).

What Makes Islamic Mortgages Unique?

Unlike conventional mortgages that involve borrowing money and paying interest over time, Islamic mortgages are structured around trade, leasing, or partnership—never interest. Islamic finance views money not as a commodity in itself, but as a means of exchange. Profit, therefore, must be earned through tangible assets and shared risk, not through lending at interest.

Using products such as *Ijara* (lease-to-own), *Murabaha* (cost-plus sale), and *Musharaka* (partnership ownership), Islamic banks purchase the property and then transfer ownership to the buyer gradually, while earning a transparent, pre-agreed profit. This structure not only aligns with Islamic ethics but also ensures clarity, fairness, and mutual responsibility between the bank and the buyer.

How Does It Work?

Here's a simplified process of how a typical Islamic mortgage works:

- The bank purchases the property you intend to buy.
- You contribute a deposit—usually between 10% and 35% depending on the agreement and lender.
- Depending on the model, you either lease the property (*Ijara*), buy it at a fixed markup (*Murabaha*), or enter a co-ownership arrangement (*Musharaka*).
- Over time, through your monthly payments, you either pay rent, buy out the bank's share, or both—until full ownership is transferred to you.

Though Sharia-compliant, these products are fully regulated by the Financial Conduct Authority (FCA), providing buyers with legal and consumer protections comparable to traditional mortgages.

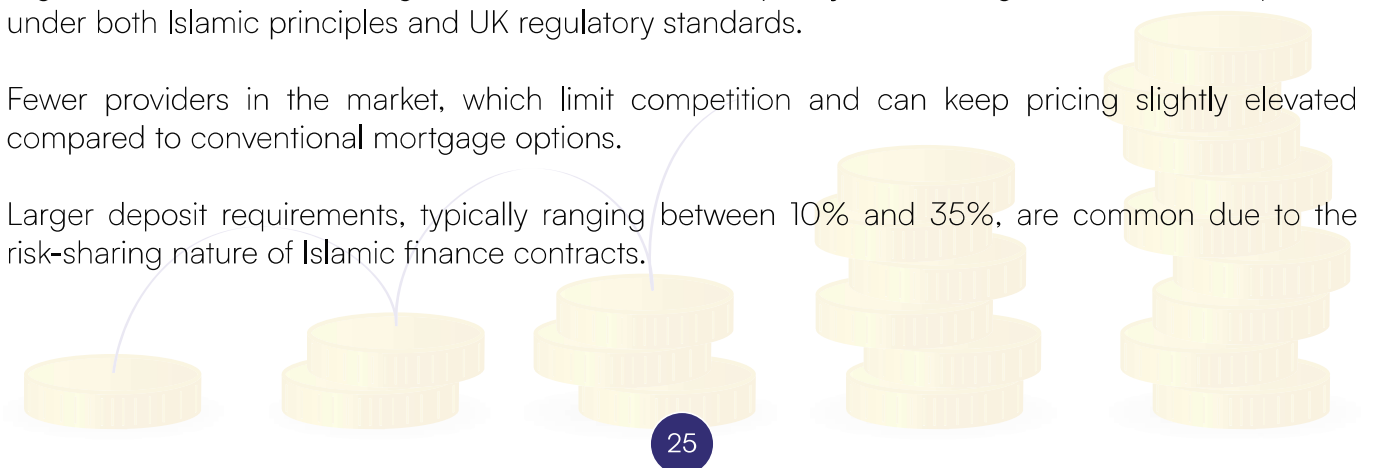
Why Are Islamic Mortgages Often More Expensive?

Islamic mortgages can, at first glance, appear more expensive than conventional interest-based mortgages. A few structural and market-based factors often influence this impression:

Higher administrative and legal costs, due to the complexity of ensuring full Shari'ah compliance under both Islamic principles and UK regulatory standards.

Fewer providers in the market, which limit competition and can keep pricing slightly elevated compared to conventional mortgage options.

Larger deposit requirements, typically ranging between 10% and 35%, are common due to the risk-sharing nature of Islamic finance contracts.



Despite these factors, Islamic mortgages offer significant long-term advantages. Unlike conventional variable-rate mortgages, many Islamic home purchase plans are structured with fixed profit rates, offering stability and protection from interest rate fluctuations. Moreover, they offer ethical and spiritual reassurance, enabling Muslims to pursue homeownership without compromising their beliefs.

Importantly, the Islamic mortgage market in the UK is growing. With more Shari'ah-compliant lenders entering the space, competition is increasing and pricing is becoming more competitive. Today, the cost difference between Islamic and conventional mortgages has narrowed to just 1% to 2%, far less than is often perceived within the Muslim community.

In essence, the actual value of an Islamic mortgage lies not just in its cost, but in its Shari'ah compliance—certified by a Shari'ah Supervisory Council comprising internationally recognised scholars in Islamic finance—and in the long-term financial clarity it provides.

Where to Find Islamic Mortgages and Remortgages in the UK?

Leading providers include:

- Gatehouse Bank (both HPP and Buy-to-Let)
- Stride Up (both HPP and Buy-to-Let)
- OFFA (only Buy-to-Let, soon coming with HPP)
- Al Rayan Bank (only for high-value properties)
- UBL UK
- Ahli Bank, BLME and Habib Bank (for high-net-worth clients)
- and more...

Why Use A Mortgage Adviser Experienced In Islamic Finance?

It is highly recommended to work with a solicitor and mortgage adviser experienced in Islamic finance, as Islamic conveyancing requires specialised expertise and distinct contractual structures. Their guidance can significantly improve your chances of securing the mortgage and completing the purchase smoothly.

Who Can Apply?

Islamic mortgages and remortgages are available to employed and self-employed individuals, as well as first-time buyers and seasoned investors. As the market grows, lenders are becoming more competitive and offering increasingly flexible options.

While rooted in Islamic principles, these ethical, interest-free products are available to anyone seeking fairness, shared responsibility, and asset-backed financing—regardless of faith.

Final Thoughts

As the UK continues to promote financial inclusivity, Islamic mortgages offer a principled, profitable and future-focused pathway to property ownership. They empower Muslims to live faithfully while building financial security—and they offer all buyers a model of ethical finance that centres on justice, transparency, and dignity.

Whether you are a first-time buyer, a growing family, employed or self-employed or an investor seeking halal returns, an Islamic mortgage may be the key to unlocking your homeownership and property investment goals—without compromising your soul or faith.

Dr. Emranul Haque

Associate Professor of Economics, The University of Manchester
Halal Asset Portfolio Consultant Islamic Mortgage Adviser
Islamic Life Coach and Prophetic Leadership Mentor & Trainer
Islamic Motivational Speaker and Fundraiser

PERSONAL FINANCES FOR PROFESSIONALS-AN ATTEMPT AT FINANCIAL ACTIVATION

Quite understandably, professionals from all walks of life tend to be focused on helping their own clients leaving little or no time to plan for themselves. This applies to Solicitors, Law firm principals and NHS GPs, as hectic life schedules mean that they often pay no attention to their personal finances; some pay the ultimate price.

The best plans are generally the simplest ones and are always started early. Although it is notoriously difficult to get some of these professionals to address their own financial matters, nevertheless once they eventually test the waters and get involved in the planning process, they find the whole experience most gratifying. Additionally, it saves them lot of time and money.

Here are the key stages of a personal financial plan.

- Understand the phase of your 'financial life'- A clear purpose statement-Retirement Focus and Work life balance.
- Review your goals regularly be prepared to have a conversation with yourself about your favourite future. Build a concrete action plan that delivers your favourite future.
- Identify key financial risks within the financial plan-Suitable Protection Planning
- Tax and Estate Planning- Understand all tax exemptions and available allowances, which include the annual ISA, pensions, income tax, dividend, and capital gains and IHT tax allowances.
- Review financial plan regularly and manage key risks.

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Sirjeel Zafar Khan
CEO Planning Wise Ltd

Chartered MCSI, ACCA, IPA, BA (econ)
Financial Life Planner/Game Plan Practitioner/Tax adviser



Beyond Profit: The ESG Imperative

How companies can create lasting value by balancing growth with responsibility

As good corporate citizens, companies must recognize that their responsibilities extend far beyond financial results. Every operation—whether resource extraction, energy consumption, or supply chain activity—directly and indirectly impact society. We draw from natural resources, but the critical question is: are we giving back in equal measure, and how do we account for that?

The answer lies in adopting sustainable practices. Recycling, renewable energy, and ethical operations are no longer optional—they are essential. True responsibility means ensuring that future generations inherit not just thriving businesses, but a healthier planet and fairer society.

This is where ESG (Environmental, Social, and Governance) comes in. ESG provides the framework to measure a company's footprint, align values with strategy, and hold leaders accountable. Investors now use ESG to assess long-term risks, customers demand ethical practices, and regulators enforce stricter standards. Profit, while vital, is no longer the sole measure of success—resilience, trust, and sustainability now define market leadership.

As ESG reporting becomes the global norm, accountants and business leaders play a pivotal role in ensuring data accuracy, linking sustainability to financial outcomes, and building transparency. Strong ESG performance doesn't just protect reputation—it strengthens competitiveness and drives lasting growth.

The future of business belongs to companies that embed ESG into their core strategy—those that balance growth with responsibility and leave behind a legacy measured not only in profit, but in positive impact.

Mohammad Sarfaraz Ninad
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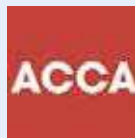
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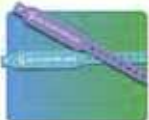
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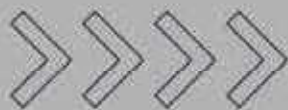
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Whether your clients are just starting out or scaling up, Tide helps you support them every step of the way.

tide



Ready to partner up?



Join the Tide Partner Programme today

*T&C's apply



Moral Parenting

With the Conviction to Build a Moral Society

WWW.MORALPARENTING.ORG



WE

- are a charity of a different kind
- support the orphaned, disabled and ultra poor but meritorious students
- provide them scholarship and guidance (Parenting) for as long as they need
- consider them as our own children and support to grow up

MAIN PROJECT: SCHOLARSHIP

- Selection of ODOMMO MEDHABI via local teachers
- Collection of scholarship from the charitable hearted persons
- Distribution of scholarship and guide through Campus Guardians

OUR SPECIALITY

- It's more than just providing scholarships; it's comprehensive support and care.
- 100% transparent money transaction system maintained by custom software
- It's a one-to-one relationship between Moral Parent and Moral Child
- Moral Parent get hand written letter from their Moral Child regularly
- Running many courses for the skill development of our children

Contact

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